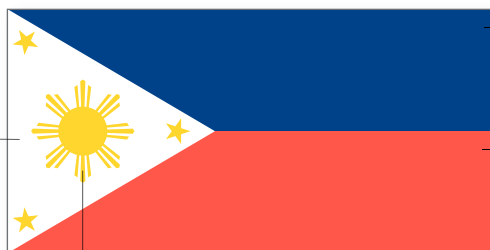


Philippines

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** May 19, 1898 **Usage:** National and Civil

The white triangle symbolizes purity and peace



Blue represents patriotism

Red symbolizes bravery

The sun and stars represent the three main areas of the country—Luzon, the Visayas, and Mindanao

Asia



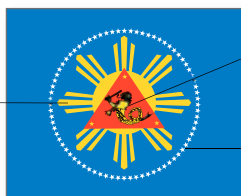
The **Philippines** was a Spanish colony until 1898, when it was ceded to the United States of America. It gained its independence in 1946.

The flag was first used by Filipino nationalists in exile while the Spanish still controlled the islands. When they were ceded to the USA, the Philippines became far more autonomous, and the flag was flown freely from 1898. It was banned by the Americans from 1907–1919, and the Stars and Stripes was flown exclusively on the islands.

The sun and stars are Masonic in origin. The eight rays of the sun are for the eight provinces that revolted against the Spanish. The three stars represent the country's three main geographical areas. White stands for purity and peace; red for bravery and blue for patriotism. When used at war, the red stripe is flown at the top of the flag, representing courage.

THE PRESIDENT'S FLAG

The sun is taken from the national flag



The three stars and a golden seal were adapted from the arms of Manila

A ring of 52 white stars of Manila